



New Cyber-shots

Sony has launched 34 new models of Cyber-shot cameras in India, priced between ₹5,490 to ₹27,990 <http://dgit.in/HZByo1>

More Top Up FeeW

TRAI has hiked the processing fee on mobile top up vouchers (Rs. 20 or more) from ₹2 to ₹3 <http://dgit.in/HZCtVL>

almost anything on the internet, provided you have the ownership.

After this, once you login, on your Google Analytics home, you can see tons and tons of statistics about your users visiting your content, you can generate custom reports, set alerts and satisfy the statistician in you to full extent. As they say enterprise scale reporting, for you, for free.

Setting up your own WebServer from Scratch

What to do if you want to have ultimate control over your hosting environment and do whatever you want with it, without having the hassles of maintaining a computer running all the time and connected to a fat internet pipe. Well cloud hosting is the answer to that solution, and one of the leading providers of cloud computing services is the Amazon Web Service suite. Here we will look at what it takes to set up your own web server and host a blog or a web-app like instagram.

As the mandatory first step you need to create your AWS account. You can sign up <http://aws.amazon.com/ec2/>. You'll have to provide a credit card and a phone number where you will be called as part of the online registration process for verification purposes. If you are uncomfortable with providing your credit card details you can use a virtual/disposable credit card also to authorise your registration. Amazon offers a free usage tier which is great to explore the services and even host real apps without being charged. The complete details of it can be found here <http://aws.amazon.com/free/> but to summarize, you get a micro-instance [enough to host a blog or simple web-app with moderate traffic] free for a whole year, including storage, network, hosting and everything. We will now do a walk-through of setting up a small linux based web server with some standard defaults, you are free to customize it if you want.

Well once you have signed in and reached your EC2 dashboard, available at <https://console.aws.amazon.com/ec2/>

home you should click on the "Launch Instance" button. Instance is nothing but one computer running in a remote location which over the internet you can control with your keyboard and mouse. A typical set up for any webserver. After that select the "Classic Wizard" and proceed by clicking on "Continue". In the next screen select the "Amazon Linux AMI 2012.03" option. It is an EBS [Elastic block storage, or simply put a hard drive] based instance so your data isn't lost every time you restart it and you can swap in swap out the drive, also this AMI [Amazon Machine Image] is optimised and supported by amazon and has a very low memory footprint, which is perfect for micro instances [613 MB of RAM]. Choose the 32 bit option within it.

Next, choose 1 as the number of instances, Micro as the type, with No preference in the availability zone [Do not select Spot Instance]. In the next screen leave everything as it is, except for selecting the



No better way to have your free computer

checkbox for "Termination Protection", which will ensure you don't accidentally delete the instance. In the next screen type a Key-Value pair if you want to identify your instance, for example "Type - WebApp" would be a good option. Then comes the important step of associating a 'Key Pair' with your instance, this is basically your authorization rights. If you know what SSH is and have a key Pair ready, then upload your public key, and use your private key to sign in, otherwise click on "Create a new key pair", give it a name, and then click on "Create and Download the new KeyPair" link. Click continue on the next screen of Security group and finally click "Launch"

and voila you have your very own free computer running in the cloud. Yes your very own dedicated computer.

Now let us see what we can do with it, after waiting for a minute or so (to let your instance boot up), go to the instances tab, right click on your instance and click connect, a pop-up will come with the instructions. You can either use a standalone SSH client (Windows users think of PuTTY, Linux users just open your command line and you have one there) or the built-in browser based client (assuming you have Java). In either case the instructions are simple and written there. I personally prefer a standalone client, use the private key (which you created and downloaded above) to authenticate yourself and login.

If you are a linux user, remember to set the permissions via `chmod 400 path_to_file.pem` as mentioned in the instructions.

Next in your browser, go to "Security Groups" from there select "Default", in there at the "Inbound" tab in the bottom pane, add 2 new rules "HTTP" and "SSH" leaving the source as default value, if the rules aren't already there, to allow people anywhere on the internet to access your web server over the HTTP protocol and for you to access it via the SSH protocol. Next you can follow any guide on setting up environment on EC2 stack for example searching for "Setting up Ruby on Rails on Amazon EC2" or "Setting up Django on Amazon EC2" on Google will provide you many great resources to set up a proper web app for the sake of demonstration let us learn how to set up WordPress

Step 1 would be to install a web server, we will go with Apache [you can pick nginx if you fancy], in the command prompt type

```
$: sudo yum install httpd
To start the Apache Web Server:
$: service httpd start
```

It would be a good idea to test your Web Server, to do this open a browser and access your web site by typing in your public DNS entry which you can get from ec2 console, by selecting your instance, and scrolling down in the bottom pane. If you type this entry (or copy paste) in the address bar you should see a test page.